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Asia Compass | Asia Pacific

China's Industrial Reinvention

What stands out to me in China's industrial story is how quickly the boundaries between technology, energy, and manufacturing are disappearing. AI needs power, power needs storage, and advanced manufacturing increasingly depends on automation, deep supply chains, and scale.

China has spent years building many of those capabilities in parallel. That creates a powerful flywheel: scale lowers costs, lower costs accelerate adoption, and faster adoption supports further investment.

The key question now is whether that industrial strength continues to translate into attractive returns. More capacity can reinforce leadership, but it can also bring price pressure, overinvestment, and greater geopolitical pushback. The next phase will be about converting scale into sustainable economic value.

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Three Key Reports: The New Architecture of Chinese Industry



China's Next Industrial Revolution

China is evolving from the world's factory into its industrial operating system, using AI, automation, supply-chain depth, and ecosystems to drive a potential \$12tn investment cycle. The aim: shift from "Made in China" to "Made by China."



Salt – the New Oil

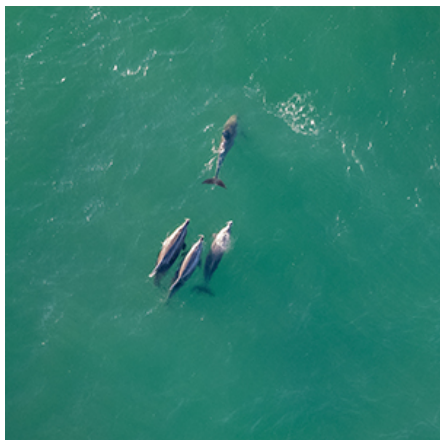
AI's power race is reshaping energy policy. Sodium-ion batteries could cut costs, reduce critical-mineral dependence, and boost cold-weather performance, supporting 3.7TWh of deployment by 2035 and an estimated \$800bn investment cycle.



The Next Chapter in China's Dominance in Global Manufacturing

China's manufacturing edge rests on more than scale. Long-term planning, R&D, AI, integrated supply chains, patient capital, and deep STEM talent help firms move up the value chain and turn technological ambition into industrial execution at speed.

Beyond the Headlines: Asset and Wealth Management: The Race for Above-Market Growth



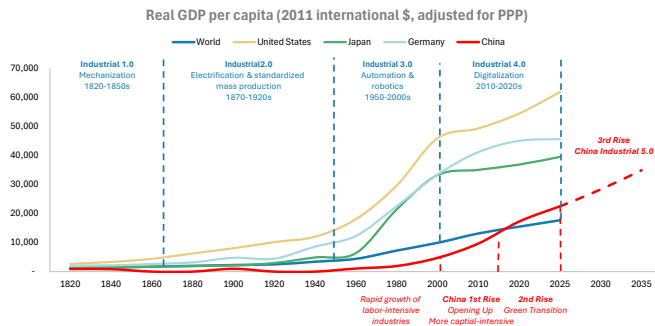
Market tailwinds should support industry growth, but leaders will separate through AI-driven productivity and earnings conversion, customization at scale to deepen portfolio and client relationships, and tokenization capabilities that broaden product utility and distribution.

[Read more](#)

Not to Be Missed

One Chart You Can't Miss

Exhibit 1: In the past few decades, China has been catching up to the world's centuries of economic growth; now China is poised to rise again with Industry 5.0



Source: Madison Project Data, IMF, Morgan Stanley Research estimates.

Must-Listen Podcast



The Mid-Cycle Shift Equity Investors Shouldn't Miss

Our CIO and Chief US Equity Strategist Mike Wilson breaks down how the market is transitioning to a mid-cycle environment, with leadership shifting toward higher-quality, asset-light companies with durable earnings.

We expect volatility to remain heightened and emphasize our wider bull-to-bear spread across the region.

Exhibit 2: Key Market Forecasts and Key Macro Forecasts

Market/Region (Index)	MS Rating	Latest Price	Jun 2027 Index Target						12mf P/E Valuations			
			Bear Case (%)		Base Case (%)		Bull Case (%)		Current	10yr Avg	% +/-	
MSCI Emerging Markets	EW	1,687	1,100		-34.8%	1,800	6.7%	2,200	30.4%	9.5	12.3	-22%
MSCI Asia Pac ex Japan	-	867	590		-32.0%	900	3.8%	1,120	29.1%	10.3	13.6	-24%
Japan (TOPIX)	OW	4,062	2,600		-36.0%	4,300	5.9%	4,900	20.6%	15.5	14.2	10%
China (MSCI China)	EW	73	60		-17.7%	80	9.7%	97	32.4%	10.2	11.8	-13%
China A-Shares (CSI 300)	-	4,480	3,290		-26.6%	4,880	8.9%	5,640	25.9%	12.7	12.4	2%
Hong Kong (Hang Seng)	EW	24,714	17,700		-28.4%	26,550	7.4%	31,900	29.1%	10.1	10.8	-6%
Australia (S&P/ASX 200)	EW	8,697	6,850		-21.2%	9,250	6.4%	10,325	18.7%	17.5	16.5	6%
India (SENSEX)	EW	74,336	66,000		-11.2%	89,000	19.7%	100,000	34.5%	19.5	21.4	-9%
South Korea (KOSPI)	OW	6,718	5,500		-18.1%	9,000	34.0%	10,500	56.3%	5.5	10.4	-47%
Latin America (MSCI LatAm)	-	3,096	2,300		-25.7%	3,600	16.3%	4,700	51.8%	9.7	10.8	-11%
Brazil (Bovespa)	OW	185,548	145,000		-21.9%	240,000	29.3%	280,000	50.9%	9.1	10.4	-13%
Mexico (MEXBOL)	EW	63,507	62,000		-2.4%	80,000	26.0%	90,000	41.7%	12.3	14.2	-14%
USA (S&P 500)	-	7,552	5,900		-21.9%	8,300	9.9%	9,400	24.5%	18.9	19.2	-2%
Europe (MSCI Europe)	-	2,544	1,820		-28.5%	2,810	10.5%	3,080	21.1%	14.3	14.2	0%

Source: FactSet, IBES, Morgan Stanley Research estimates. Data as of 16 September, 2026

Exhibit 3: Key Cross-asset Allocation Views

Global Asset Allocation					Relative Equity Allocation					Relative Tsy Allocation				
Equities					US					USTs				
Bonds					Europe					EGBs				
Credit					Japan					JGBs				
Comms					EM									
Cash														

Source: Morgan Stanley Research

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(as of August 31, 2026)

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Stock Rating Category	Coverage Universe		Investment Banking Clients (IBC)			Other Material Investment Services Clients (MISC)	
	Count	% of Total	Count	% of Total IBC	% of Rating Category	Count	% of Total Other MISC
Overweight/Buy	1555	42%	450	48%	29%	767	44%
Equal-weight/Hold	1577	43%	395	42%	25%	770	44%
Not-Rated/Hold	3	0%	1	0%	33%	1	0%
Underweight/Sell	559	15%	93	10%	17%	216	12%
Total	3,694		939			1754	

Data include common stock and ADRs currently assigned ratings. Investment Banking Clients are companies from whom Morgan Stanley received investment banking compensation in the last 12 months. Due to rounding off of decimals, the percentages provided in the "% of total" column may not add up to exactly 100 percent.

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